

Letting Go — The Practice

20–25 min · Week 12 · PPRA · Counselor Briefed

OBJECTIVE	Students practise the symbolic act of "putting it down" — releasing one small piece of weight they have been carrying.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · symbolic release; emotional regulation
VOCABULARY	put it down · release · practice · again and again · heavy · light
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · smooth stones (one per student) · small basket or bowl · optional substitute object for tactile-sensitive students

SAFETY CHECK

PPRA-designated lesson. Family notification confirmed. Standard opt-out protocols apply. Counselor briefed in advance. Counselor on standby — reachable same-day. The stone practice may activate students carrying significant weight. They may become quietly emotional. This is the practice working. Do not draw class attention. Acknowledge privately. Substitute object available for tactile-sensitive students (e.g., a small piece of fabric, a folded paper).

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Kind Message cards from Lesson 4. "Last lesson: be kind to yourself. Today: a way to PRACTISE letting go of something heavy.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have been carrying something for a while. Today I want to try — just try — putting it down."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

Distribute Stones

3 MIN

Each student receives a stone (or substitute object). They hold it in their hand. "Feel the weight. Notice how it feels in your hand."

2

The Stone Holds the Heavy

5 MIN

Frame the practice: "Right now — your stone is holding ONE small heavy thing. It can be a mistake you made. Or a hurt feeling. Or a mean thing you said to yourself. You do NOT have to tell anyone what it is. You just hold it in the stone.**"